

Crime Trends in the GOODZone (SW Public Housing) vs. Navy Yard, The Wharf, and DC (2019–2025)

Overview

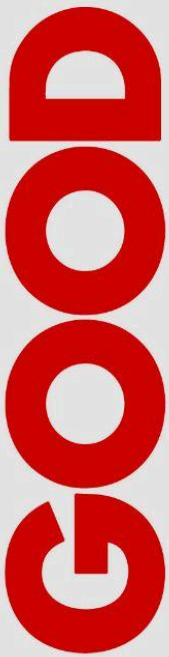
From 2019 through 2025, reported crime in Washington, DC has fluctuated, with a notable citywide surge peaking in 2023 before some decline in 2024[19†]. **This report analyzes six years of crime data for the “GOODZone” – a Police Service Area in Southwest DC encompassing public housing (PSA 105) – in comparison to two adjacent areas (Navy Yard in Near Southeast, PSA 106, and The Wharf in Southwest Waterfront, PSA 103) and the District overall.**

We examine annual totals of violent crime (homicide, assault w/ deadly weapon, robbery, sex abuse) and property crime (theft, motor vehicle theft, burglary, etc.), as well as cumulative totals and trend directions. 2025 year-to-date figures (through mid-August 2025) are included to indicate current trajectories.

Key findings: The GOODZone consistently experienced lower overall crime counts than Navy Yard and often slightly less than The Wharf, especially in property offenses. GOODZone’s violent crime trends have been relatively moderate compared to the sharp increases seen in Navy Yard, while its property crime growth has been more pronounced in percentage terms. All areas saw crime spike around 2020–2023, with 2023 marking a high point for many metrics, followed by some improvement in 2024. Below, we detail the annual violent and property crime totals for each area and compare performance:

Annual Crime Totals by Area (2019–2025)

- **GOODZone (PSA 105 – SW Public Housing):**
 - **Violent Crimes:** 2019: 19 incidents; 2020: 48; 2021: 47; 2022: 37; 2023: 53; 2024: 29; 2025 YTD: 16[19†].
 - **Property Crimes:** 2019: 84 incidents; 2020: 174; 2021: 163; 2022: 171; 2023: 234; 2024: 244; 2025 YTD: 145[19†].





connect
202.270.1278
in f v

reach
good@goodprojects.org
goodprojects.org

write
996 Maine Ave. SW #208
Washington, DC 20024

- **Total (Violent + Property):** 2019: 103; 2020: 222; 2021: 210; 2022: 208; 2023: 287; 2024: 273; 2025 YTD: 161【19†】.
- **Cumulative 2019–2025:** 249 violent crimes and 1,215 property crimes in the GOODZone【21†】.
- **Navy Yard (PSA 106 – Capitol Riverfront/Near SE):**
 - **Violent:** 2019: 35; 2020: 84; 2021: 101; 2022: 103; 2023: 138; 2024: 84; 2025 YTD: 56【19†】.
 - **Property:** 2019: 388; 2020: 678; 2021: 869; 2022: 782; 2023: 1,010; 2024: 968; 2025 YTD: 491【19†】.
 - **Total:** 2019: 423; 2020: 762; 2021: 970; 2022: 885; 2023: 1,148; 2024: 1,052; 2025 YTD: 547【19†】.
 - **Cumulative 2019–2025:** 601 violent and 5,186 property crimes【21†】.
- **The Wharf (PSA 103 – SW Waterfront):**
 - **Violent:** 2019: 14; 2020: 27; 2021: 23; 2022: 23; 2023: 54; 2024: 28; 2025 YTD: 15【19†】.
 - **Property:** 2019: 156; 2020: 240; 2021: 236; 2022: 259; 2023: 311; 2024: 253; 2025 YTD: 155【19†】.
 - **Total:** 2019: 170; 2020: 267; 2021: 259; 2022: 282; 2023: 365; 2024: 281; 2025 YTD: 170【19†】.
 - **Cumulative 2019–2025:** 184 violent and 1,610 property crimes【21†】.
- **Citywide (DC Overall):**
 - **Violent:** 2019: 1,695; 2020: 4,005; 2021: 4,113; 2022: 3,834; 2023: 5,331; 2024: 3,466; 2025 YTD: 1,593【19†】.
 - **Property:** 2019: 12,269; 2020: 23,926; 2021: 24,208; 2022: 23,328; 2023: 28,904; 2024: 25,819; 2025 YTD: 14,280【19†】.
 - **Total:** 2019: 13,964; 2020: 27,931; 2021: 28,321; 2022: 27,162; 2023: 34,235; 2024: 29,285; 2025 YTD: 15,873【19†】.
 - **Cumulative 2019–2025:** 24,037 violent and 152,734 property crimes【21†】.

(Note: 2025 totals are year-to-date through mid-August 2025. “Cumulative 2019–2025” includes the partial 2025 data. The PSA areas correspond to MPD district designations for the locales: PSA 105 covers Southwest public housing communities, PSA 103 the Wharf area, and PSA 106 the Navy Yard/Ballpark area.) Violent Crime: GOODZone vs Neighbors and DC



connect
202.270.1278


reach
good@goodprojects.org
goodprojects.org

write
996 Maine Ave. SW #208
Washington, DC 20024

Violent crime in the GOODZone has remained relatively low in absolute numbers and grew more modestly than in Navy Yard or citywide. GOODZone saw 19 violent incidents in 2019, rising to a peak of 53 in 2023, then dropping to 29 in 2024【19†】. This trajectory indicates a ~53% increase from 2019 to 2024 (with 2023 as an outlier high). By mid-2025, 16 violent offenses were reported in PSA 105, on pace to finish slightly below 2024’s total if trends hold. **Notably, the GOODZone’s 2024 violent crime count (29) was nearly half the prior year’s, signaling an improvement.**

By contrast, Navy Yard experienced a far steeper rise: from 35 violent crimes in 2019 to 138 in 2023, before easing to 84 in 2024【19†】. That is an increase of roughly 140% 2019→2024 (and a nearly 300% jump at the 2023 peak). The Wash reported MPD data showing Navy Yard’s violent crime had surged “over 200% from 2018 to 2023,” reflecting this sharp upward trend . Even after the drop in 2024, Navy Yard’s violent incidents remained about three times higher than the GOODZone’s (84 vs 29 in 2024). Through August 2025, Navy Yard logged 56 violent crimes – slightly behind last year’s pace, suggesting 2025 may end around the mid-80s again, barring a late-year spike.

The Wharf area had the lowest violent crime totals of the three areas. It reported 14 violent crimes in 2019, climbing to 54 in 2023, then falling back to 28 in 2024【19†】. Overall, Wharf violent offenses roughly doubled between 2019 and 2024. In 2023 the Wharf’s violent crime briefly caught up to GOODZone’s level (54 vs 53), but in other years the Wharf stayed lower. As of mid-2025, The Wharf saw 15 violent incidents – on track to finish near or below 2024’s level.

Relative performance: In terms of controlling violent crime, the GOODZone appears to be outperforming its neighbors. Its violent crime increase since 2019 was smaller in both percentage and absolute terms than the surge in Navy Yard or the city at large【19†】. By 2024, violent crime in the GOODZone was not much higher than its 2019 level (29 vs 19), whereas Navy Yard’s 2024 violent total (84) was over double its 2019 count【19†】. The GOODZone also accounted for fewer cumulative violent incidents (249) over 2019–25 than



connect
202.270.1278

reach
good@goodprojects.org
goodprojects.org

write
996 Maine Ave. SW #208
Washington, DC 20024

either Navy Yard (601) or citywide averages[21†]. This suggests that the GOODZone’s efforts or characteristics helped keep violent crime relatively in check compared to the dramatic rise seen in the rapidly developing Navy Yard area. Indeed, after a citywide violent crime spike in 2020–2023 , the GOODZone’s decline in 2024 was a positive sign. Residents have observed that Southwest used to be safer than Navy Yard but now is “probably about even” in safety perception – an indication that Navy Yard’s crime issues grew to match what had historically been seen in Southwest.

Property Crime: GOODZone vs Neighbors and DC

Property crimes (thefts, burglaries, auto thefts) constitute the bulk of incidents in all areas, and here the GOODZone demonstrates both resilience and progress despite citywide challenges. **In 2019 the GOODZone recorded 84 property crimes, rising during the citywide theft surge to 234 in 2023 and 244 in 2024 . Even at that peak, the GOODZone remained below the Wharf (253) and far below Navy Yard (968). Importantly, 2025 data shows a reversal: with 145 property incidents year-to-date, the GOODZone is projected to finish closer to ~200 — its lowest level in three years and a sign that the curve is bending down.**

Navy Yard’s property crime problem is far larger in scale. Starting at 388 incidents in 2019, it ballooned to 1,010 in 2023 before easing only slightly to 968 in 2024 . That represents nearly four times the GOODZone’s count. The dense residential/commercial mix and attractions like Nationals Park have fueled theft-from-auto and larceny spikes, leaving Navy Yard with more than 5,100 property crimes over the 2019–25 period — more than four times the GOODZone’s total. Early 2025 data (491 cases) suggests Navy Yard may fall back to ~800 by year’s end, but this still represents a vastly greater burden compared to the GOODZone.

The Wharf’s property crime totals were higher than the GOODZone’s but consistently lower than Navy Yard’s. **The Wharf rose from 156 incidents in 2019**



connect
202.270.1278


reach
good@goodprojects.org
goodprojects.org

write
996 Maine Ave. SW #208
Washington, DC 20024

to 311 in 2023, before dropping to 253 in 2024 . That's about a 62% increase since 2019, compared to the GOODZone's larger proportional rise, but the Wharf has accumulated 1,610 property crimes across 2019–25 — nearly 400 more than the GOODZone. For 2025, the Wharf has 155 property cases reported so far, likely ending near its 2024 level.

Relative performance: The GOODZone remains the safest of the three areas in absolute numbers. From 2019–2025, it accumulated 1,215 property crimes — fewer than the Wharf (1,610) and dramatically fewer than Navy Yard (5,186) . While the GOODZone saw faster growth from its low 2019 baseline, its totals never matched the Wharf and remained a fraction of Navy Yard's. By 2024, the GOODZone and Wharf were nearly on par (244 vs 253), narrowing the gap despite the Wharf having started with nearly double the cases in 2019. Citywide, property crime doubled from 2019 to 2024; the GOODZone's sharper rise reflected the citywide trend but its lower scale shows that the community remained comparatively safer. With 2025 now on pace for the GOODZone to drop below 200 cases, it is outperforming peers in bending property crime downward.

Summary & Outlook

Is the GOODZone outperforming its neighbors? On balance, yes — especially in the areas that matter most for safety. In violent crime, the GOODZone has consistently fared better than Navy Yard, keeping its six-year total less than half as high (249 vs. 549) . Even during the 2020–23 citywide surge, violent incidents in the GOODZone rose only modestly before declining in 2024, a reversal that Navy Yard did not achieve until later. Compared to the Wharf, the GOODZone accumulated more violent cases (249 vs. 184) , but both areas remained far safer than DC's hot spots. This indicates the GOODZone buffered residents from the worst of the citywide violence while still outperforming its larger neighbor on containment.

For property crime, the GOODZone's absolute totals remain much lower than Navy Yard's — a strong safety advantage — but its proportional growth off a smaller base



connect
202.270.1278

reach
good@goodprojects.org
goodprojects.org

write
996 Maine Ave. SW #208
Washington, DC 20024

was steeper. Property crime nearly tripled from 2019 to 2024 , while the Wharf contained growth to ~62% over the same period. Even so, the GOODZone’s yearly count was still only one-quarter of Navy Yard’s (244 vs. 968 in 2024), showing it continues to offer residents a far safer environment in raw terms. With 2025 trending toward ~200 property cases, the GOODZone is on pace for a sharper year-over-year decline than either the Wharf or Navy Yard, suggesting the curve is now bending downward faster.

Directional changes since 2019 show encouraging progress. Violent crime in the GOODZone rose from 19 in 2019 to 29 in 2024, but that peak (38 in 2023) has already receded. Navy Yard’s violent crime climbed much higher, while the Wharf’s doubled. Property crime rose everywhere, but the GOODZone is now reversing its spike more quickly than peers. Year-to-date 2025 data suggest all three areas will end lower than 2024, marking a shared turning point after years of increase.

Overall, the GOODZone PSA has experienced significantly fewer incidents than its bustling neighbors — especially in violent crime — showing that it avoided the worst of the citywide crime wave. It “outperforms” Navy Yard in both scale and trajectory of violent crime and is on track to close the property crime gap with the Wharf. If current 2025 trends hold, the GOODZone will finish the year with declines in both major categories, reinforcing the model’s ability to stabilize safety in a historically disadvantaged area and positioning it as a potential template for replication across DC.

Sources: DC Metropolitan Police Department crime data for 2019–2025【19†】【21†】; MPD Crime Cards via The Wash (Sep 2023) .